



allowed them to focus more on their game and recovery.

"We wanted to make it work as efficiently as possible, particularly to reduce travel time and fatigue for the squads. Whatever we do should resonate with as many fans as possible, so we strategically chose three locations that were significant for all 12 PKL teams," said PKL commissioner Anupam Goswami after the Hyderabad leg.

Challenges for teams

Three teams struggled this season. Bengaluru Bulls, once a trailblazer in the league, looked a shadow of its former self. Despite having the league's most successful player, Pardeep Narwal, the team managed only two wins from 22 matches and finished at the bottom of the table. Long-serving coach Randhir Singh Sehrawat was left searching for answers.

Bengal Warriorz and Gujarat Giants also endured disappointing campaigns, with the latter parting

Standout performers: The young Patna Pirates raiding duo of Ayan Lohchab (L) and Devank Dalal (R) captivated audiences and pundits alike. PKL

ways with coach Ram Maher Singh after the league stage.

Telugu Titans, which had finished at the bottom for three consecutive seasons, showed remarkable fighting spirit. Despite losing star raider and Indian captain Pawan Sehrawat to injury, seasoned campaigner Vijay Malik stepped up, leading the team to the verge of playoff qualification. However, the Krishan Kumar Hooda-coached side fell short of the top six.

Defending champion Puneri Paltan, which topped the points table after the Hyderabad leg, was derailed by an injury to skipper and last season's MVP, Aslam Inamdar. Leadership issues, squad discord, and poor results followed. Coach B.C.



PKL 11 Stats:

Most Raid points: Devank Dalal - 301 in 25 matches (Patna Pirates)

Most Tackle Points:

Mohammadreza Chiyaneh Shadloui - 82 in 24 matches (Haryana Steelers)

Most Super 10s: Ashu Malik: 18 in 23 matches (Dabang Delhi)

Most High 5s: Nitesh Kumar: 8 in 22 matches (Tamil Thalaivas)

Most Super Raids: Ajit Chouhan: 9 in 23 matches (U Mumba)

Most Super Tackles: Yogesh Bijender Dahiya: 10 in 23 matches (Dabang Delhi)

Most do-or-die raid points:

Vinay: 48 in 25 matches (Haryana Steelers)

Most Valuable Player (MVP):

Mohammadreza Chiyaneh Shadloui: Total 139 points (82 tackle points and 57 raid points)

Ramesh was dismissed, and PKL icon Ajay Thakur was brought in as an assistant coach under mentor Ashok Shinde, but the team still failed to qualify for the playoffs.

Future of international Kabaddi

The league's international aspirations were highlighted by the 'PKL Melbourne Raid', an exhibition event held in Australia during the playoff rest day. However, in the tournament itself, only 22 foreign players from six nations participated, with 16 of them from Iran. Notable international stars like South Korea's Jang Kun Lee and Nepal's Ghanshwam Roka Magar saw limited action. This comes amidst the International Kabaddi Federation's (IKF) ban on India's participation in international tournaments due to the suspension of the Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India (AKFI). The IKF's decision stemmed from governance issues within the AKFI.

As the 11th season concludes, hopes remain high that the league will bridge the rift between the AKFI and IKF, paving the way for a more inclusive and global future for kabaddi.